emerge as one of the largest peach growers in California by the end of the century. Thus, Punjabi wanderlust sent people and money far and wide across the world. The spirit was infectious and certainly caught on in neighbouring Sindh.

The Global Sindhi Stereotype

Sindh lies where the Indus meets the Arabian Sea, and is now a province in present-day Pakistan. It was earlier a part of the Bombay Presidency from 1847 to 1936.[35] With riverine origins, the Sindhis have meandered across the world through different circular migratory paths over the past few centuries. Within India, the Sindhis usually refer to Hindus who migrated from Sindh either before or after Partition with a high proclivity of having surnames ending in ‘ani’, as in Advani, or ‘ja’, as in Raheja.

The Hindu Sindhis are today seen as offshoots of the disintegration of the British Empire, but the community has historically been mobile and was itself a creation of the messy disintegration of the Mughal and Safavid empires in the 18th century.[36] To escape violence and declining commercial opportunities, many Khatri merchants from Multan, and the broader Punjab region, headed south towards Sindh. Here, they would lose some of their pre-migration identities and be absorbed into the Lohana caste which would over time dominate the Hindu population of Shikarpur and Hyderabad towns in Sindh, and form a fifth of the Hindu population in Karachi.[37] Within the Lohana grouping, two important sub-castes were the *Amil*s in administrative services and the *Bhaiband*s in trade and commerce. Outside the Lohana group were the Sindhi Bhatias and Brahmins, and they collectively exhibited a multicultural ethos which respected Guru Nanak, the founder of Sikhism (most Hindu Sindhis are *Nanakpanthi*s), the pantheon of Hindu gods, especially their beloved Jhulelal, and Sufi pirs.

From the middle of the 19th century, Sindhi men began migrating to set-up an unusually wide transnational mercantile network stretching ‘from Bukhara to Panama’.[38] Bukhara (Uzbekistan), central Asia and later the Indian subcontinent would be destinations for the Shikarpuri bankers to